

Lord, I want to be a Christian

Text: African-American spiritual,
Folk Songs of the American Negro, 1907
LORD, I WANT TO BE irregular

Music: African-American spiritual,
Folk Songs of the American Negro, 1907

The musical score is written for a single voice in treble clef, key of B-flat major (three flats), and 4/4 time. It consists of four staves of music. The first staff contains four numbered lines of lyrics. The second staff continues the melody with the lyrics 'Lord, I want to be a Chris-tian in my heart.' The third staff features a melodic phrase with the lyrics 'In my heart, in my heart,'. The fourth staff concludes the piece with the lyrics 'Lord, I want to be a Chris-tian in my heart.' and ends with a double bar line. The melody is simple and characteristic of African-American spirituals, with a mix of quarter, eighth, and half notes, and some phrasing slurs.

1 Lord, I want to be a Chris-tian in my heart, in my heart.
2 Lord, I want to be more lov - ing...
3 Lord, I want to be more ho - ly...
4 Lord, I want to be like Je - sus...

Lord, I want to be a Chris-tian in my heart.

In my heart, in my heart,

Lord, I want to be a Chris-tian in my heart.